

Smruti Ranjan Dash

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OVERVIEW

Cybersecurity Analyst with 4+ years of experience in enterprise security operations, incident response, Security Information and Event Monitoring (SIEM), endpoint and email security, and Identity and Access Management (IAM). Strong hands-on experience with **Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender XDR, Intune, Active Directory, Zscaler, Public Key Infrastructure (PKI), and ServiceNow**, complemented by a solid understanding in risk assessment, threat modeling, Data Loss Prevention (Microsoft Purview) and ISO 27001/NIST-aligned governance. **CompTIA Security+** certified and currently preparing for **CISSP**.

EDUCATION

Master of Information Security & Privacy (MISP)

University of Calgary (GPA: 3.84/4.0)

Graduated: 2025

Alberta, Canada

Relevant Coursework: Applied Cryptography | Network Security | Ethical Hacking Lab | Private Data Management | Governance & Risk Management | Policies, Procedures & Programs

Bachelor of Technology (BTech) in Computer Science & Engineering

Biju Pattnaik University of Technology (GPA: 8.32/10.0)

Graduated: 2020

Odisha, India

WORK EXPERIENCE

Cybersecurity Intern

Digital Nexus AI

Apr 2025 – Aug 2025

New Jersey, USA (Remote, Canada-based)

- Conducted **vulnerability analysis** using Nessus/OpenVAS, validated findings, prioritized risks, and tracked remediations.
- Performed **threat modeling** for AI based wearable device architecture, identifying data exposure risks, and required mitigating controls.

Senior Security Analyst

HCLTech (MSSP for Stanley Black & Decker, Mosaic & more)

Oct 2020 – Jul 2024

Chennai, India

- Operated in a **24x7 SOC with rotational shifts**, supporting business-critical enterprise systems and responding to security incidents impacting end users.
- Monitored and triaged alerts from **Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender XDR, and Palo Alto Cortex XDR**, performing initial investigation, and first-level containment actions.
- Investigated **phishing incidents** by analyzing SPF/DKIM/DMARC, reviewing URLs and attachments, and updating filtering rules in Proofpoint and Defender.
- Performed end-to-end **incident response**: log review, event correlation, triage, containment, and investigation using **KQL** in Microsoft Sentinel and Defender, reducing incident resolution time by **12–14 hours** through effective ticket handling in **ServiceNow**.
- Reviewed and validated **IOCs from internal and external threat feeds**; built an IOC validation automation tool (Excel VBA/Python) that improved ingestion efficiency by **60%**.
- Performed **PKI troubleshooting**, managing certificate renewals, validation failures, and trust chain issues to resolve authentication problems across distributed environments.
- Administered and troubleshooted **Zscaler ZIA (Zscaler Internet Access)** issues for 300+ endpoints, collaborating with IT, network, and cloud teams to enforce security policies.
- Collaborated with teams to resolve issues on the **SecurityScorecard platform**, enhancing the **overall security posture by 20 points**.
- Documented procedures for repetitive incidents, playbooks to standardize security operations and documented detailed timeline for security incidents to improve audit readiness.

Summer Intern (Mobile App Developer)

Hindustan Aeronautics Limited

Jun 2019 – Aug 2019

Odisha, India

- Developed a cross-platform mobile application for food delivery using React Native, contributing to an increase of 30% in user engagement.

PROJECTS

Security-by-Design Capstone project – TalentForge

May 2025 – Aug 2025

- Served as the **Security Lead**, gathering security requirements in collaboration with Business, Risk, and Privacy teams to ensure secure solution design.
- Authored all **security policies, privacy policies, access control workflows**, and system diagrams aligned with NIST and ISO frameworks.
- Mapped identity, access, and security controls to platform components; conducted basic risk assessments and remediation planning.

AWS Cloud Security Assessment

Aug 2024 – Nov 2024

- Evaluated AWS workloads using **ScoutSuite**, identifying misconfigurations and producing remediation recommendations aligned with CIS benchmarks.

ISO 27001 ISMS Security Business Plan

Nov 2024 – Dec 2024

- Performed risk assessments, mapped ISO 27001 controls, and produced governance documents to support audit and compliance readiness.

Vulnerability Management & Pentest Simulation

Nov 2024 – Dec 2024

- Performed vulnerability scans (Nessus/OpenVAS), simulated exploitation, validated attack paths, and produced remediation guidance for stakeholders.

TECHNICAL CERTIFICATIONS

- [Zscaler Digital Transformation Administrator \(ZDTA\)](#) *Oct 2025*
- [CompTIA Security+](#) *Jan 2025*
- [Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate](#) *Mar 2024*

ADDITIONAL SECTION

- **Languages:** English (fluent), French (basic – learning)
- **Location:** Based in Lethbridge, Alberta; prefer on-site work and available to support after-hours operations as required.